Since it was launched in 2013, the Belt and Road Initiative has been turned into China's flagship project, and it is backed by financial connectivity through the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank, the Silk Road Fund, the China-Eurasian Economic Cooperation Fund, and the SCO Interbank Consortium. One landmark event was in May 2015, when China and Russia signed a joint declaration of the connection of the Silk Road Economic Belt and Russia's Eurasian Economic Union. Both India and China are keen to revive what was once the world's richest trading network across the Indian Ocean, from China to West Asia with India in between. In fact, India is a geographical lynchpin for China's Belt and Road Initiative, and this Chinese initiative affords India a historic opportunity to play a pivotal role in the region. However, India has so far been more reluctant than other countries in the region to link up with BRI and did not participate in the two first high-level BRI summits hosted by China in 2017 and 2019.[40]

While India expressed its desire to cooperate with the Moscow-led EAEU in 2015, it did not quite approve of Beijing's BRI idea. Instead, it has expressed its resentment towards China's plans for the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor through Pakistan-occupied Kashmir. The BRI has put India in a quandary, as a set of projects envisaged under BRI/CPEC could transform the region north of India into a new economic hub and a zone of joint projects, which would definitely have an impact on India.

Even though the SCO is mainly an organisation coordinating non-traditional security concerns and the BRI a large-scale economic connectivity project, the BRI is already deeply embedded in the SCO's cooperation framework. Most SCO members, observers, and dialogue partners are geographically located within the reach of the Belt and Road Initiative, and China portrays the spirits of the two cooperation frameworks, the SCO and the BRI, to be in line